

Cithara Versio

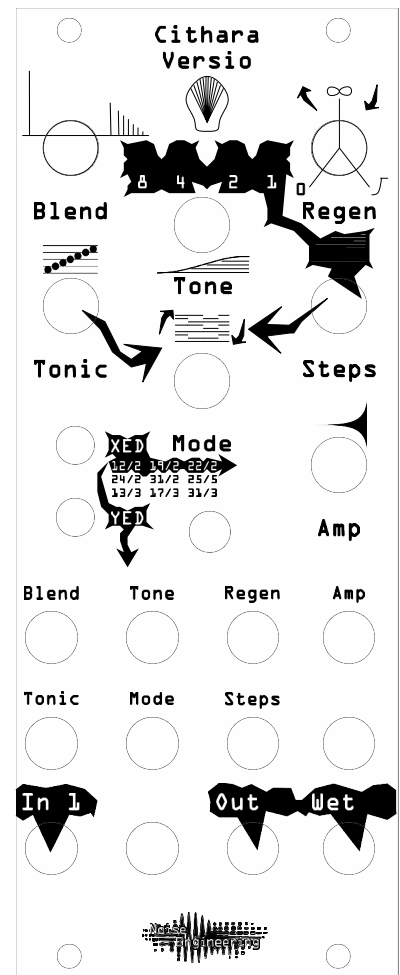
Mono-in, mono-out sympathetic string tail-generator

Overview

Cithara Versio provides a portable version of the Ondes Martenot's Palme Resonator. The ondes sound could be routed through a "speaker" made up of an octave of chromatic strings that vibrate sympathetically with its buzzy waveforms. These strings help the ondist find specific pitches in the scale. In this version, the user can retune the root of the strings with the turn of a knob or select alternative tunings with the flip of a switch. Explore the settings to find metallic, nylon, and wooden resonances.

A simple USB connection allows you to upload this alternative firmware to any Noise Engineering Versio module using the Daisy Web Programmer.

It's easy to return to your original Versio firmware at the [World of Versio](#) page.



Etymology

Cithara -- from Latin: "*harp or lyre*"

Versio -- from Latin: "*versatile*"

"Versatile Zither"

Interface

Blend

Dry/wet balance control. When turned fully left, the unmodified input signal is passed through. Fully right, only the processed signal is heard. Points in the middle give you a mix of both.

Tone

A low pass filter on each string. Turning the knob left dampens each string. To the left, the harmonics brightly ring.

Regen

Amount of feedback on each string. All the way to the left, the feedback is minimized. Past midway, a the regen is subject to a ducking effect.

Tonic

Tuning offset for all strings. The tuning stretches across three octaves.

Mode

When Steps is not at maximum, Mode rotates the intervals of the scale into new musical mode configurations.

Steps

On full right, up to 19 strings are activated, spreading across the range of the scale set by XED and YED. Turning to the left reduces the number of active scale steps distributing them evenly across the octave, tritave, or quintive. At the far left, only one karplus-strong string resonator remains. Through this control, you can get a 7 note scale out of 12 chromatic divisions or a pentatonic scale out of 19 divisions.

Amp

The internal filters can reduce the level of the signal, but the feedback can also cause signal boosts. This knob adjusts the output level. Towards the right, the signal can overdrive with a soft tanh distortion.

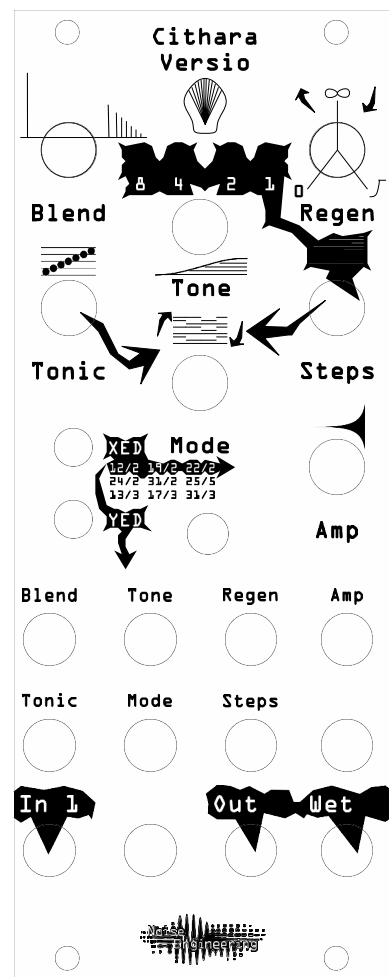
XED and YED

Equal divisions of the octave, tritave, or quintive. The 3-way switches select preset tunings for the sympathetic strings. YED selects rows. XED selects columns.

edY left: 12edo (chromatic), 19edo, 22edo.

edY middle: 24edo (quarter-tone), 31edo, 25ed5 (Stockhausen, *Studie II*).

edY right: 13ed3 (Bohlen-Pierce), 17ed3, 31ed3.



Disclaimer

You install new firmware to your Versio at your own risk. Follow Noise Engineering's firmware installation guide. Don't connect the USB while the Versio is powered up. Never lean your module against anything while powering it from your rack. This can blow out components. Always screw it back into the rack before powering on.

Flashing Firmware

A simple USB connection allows you to upload this alternative firmware to any Noise Engineering Versio module using the Daisy Web Programmer. It's easy to return your original Versio firmware at the World of Versio page.

Note: the Versio (Daisy) board pictured is upside-down.

- While your Versio is unpowered, connect it to your computer with a USB cable capable of transferring data.

- In a Chrome-based browser, navigate to flash.daisy.audio.

- Click the File Upload tab and click CHOOSE FILE to upload CitharaVersio.bin. This prepares you to quickly flash the file, later, while the bootloader is waiting.

- Click the Bootloader tab and select the default v6.4 bootloader option.

- While holding button 1, momentarily press button 2 before releasing button 1. This will pair the Versio with Chrome in DFU/FS mode.

- Press the FLASH button on the website. When the bootloader flashing completes, the LED near button 1 will slowly pulse.

- Switch to the File Upload tab and click FLASH.

- Wait for the process to finish. Disconnect your USB cable, and power on your system to test.

- If the process fails, repeat installation of the bootloader before attempting to flash the CitharaVersio.bin again.

